

Thursday, 27 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Showers

25° 18°

BIRMINGHAM

Heavy rain

22° 17°

MANCHESTER

Showers

19° 16°

GLASGOW

Overcast

21° 16°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Nepalese authorities say 33 UK nationals missing after flash floods.

Flooding and mud slides hit the Rasuwa region in the morning on Wednesday, killing at least 95 people, Nepali police said.

UK · NEWS

2

Prince Harry and Meghan land in UK days after announcing move.

Prince Harry, Meghan, and their two children are believed to have flown into the country privately from California.

UK · NEWS

3

Inquest begins into death of Jason Arday.

Dr Julian Morris said he had "reason to suspect that Professor Arday died an unnatural death".

UK · NEWS

4

Stourbridge fires that razed 19 homes accidental.

Investigators say the fires started accidentally in fields where farming machinery was being used.

UK · NEWS

5

King and Queen to visit the Caribbean in autumn tour.

The eight-day visit will see the royal pair travel to Antigua before King Charles travels to the Bahamas and Guyana.

UK · NEWS

What's coming up

- 1 Heart, hope and a steely determination: Dolly Parton's musical legacy.**
BBC music correspondent Mark Savage looks back on the legacy of the "irreplaceable" late singer.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Taylor Swift and Beyoncé lead tributes after death of 'bold and brilliant' Dolly Parton.**
Tributes pour in from across the worlds of music, film and politics for the star, who has died at 80.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 Maura Higgins to fill Cilla Black's shoes as host of Blind Date reboot.**
The Love Island and Traitors US TV personality will host a reboot of the popular dating show.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 4 Rupert Grint to return to Harry Potter in Broadway play.**
Grint, now 38, will play his character as an adult in the Harry Potter spin-off play in New York.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 5 How Dolly Parton told her life story through six iconic songs.**
A legendary singer-songwriter, her music covered themes around love, loss, female empowerment and spirituality.
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 Liverpool turn attention to Sarr after Brighton reject Minteh bids.**
Liverpool are exploring a move for Crystal Palace's Ismaila Sarr after Brighton reject their two bids for Yankuba Minteh.
SPORT · UK
- 2 Another season, another failure - where did it all go wrong for Celtic?.**
Celtic have now faltered in Champions League qualifying on six occasions in eight years. What are the ramifications this time?
SPORT · UK
- 3 Uefa set to drop Fifa tournament boycott threat.**
Uefa is set to drop its threat of boycotting Fifa competitions, having received assurances there will be no repeat of Gianni Infantino's plan to sell off stakes in the World Cup to private investors, BBC Sport has been told.
SPORT · UK
- 4 Chelsea in contact over move for Villa goalkeeper Martinez.**
Chelsea consider a move for Aston Villa goalkeeper Emiliano Martinez after making contact with the Argentina international's representatives.
SPORT · UK
- 5 'The record will fall' - Werro takes aim at 43-year-old 800m mark.**
European 800m champion Audrey Werro backs herself to overhaul one of athletics' oldest and most controversial world records.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Board game cafés are booming on UK high streets.**
Owners say the biggest sellers are the quick, daft games — not the four-hour epics. The most common cause of fallouts remains the rules of a certain word game.
- 2 More than half of UK workers would take a 10% pay cut to never go into the office again — but only 17% of bosses say they'd offer one.**
The gap is growing again after forced return-to-office rules. HR experts say the tension shows up in resignation rates, particularly for under-35s.
- 3 One in three of us has had a 'sleep divorce' — sleeping in a separate bed from our partner.**
Reasons: snoring (45%), different schedules (30%), restless legs, and one bizarre 12% who say their partner 'talks to the cat in their sleep'.
- 4 A survey says most of us have a 'signature dish' we bring out whenever guests come round.**
Chilli, lasagne and a roast top the list. Very few of us, it turns out, have a second dish ready if the first goes wrong.
- 5 Brits spend an average of 38 minutes a day deciding what to watch — and 12 of those are spent scrolling Netflix.**
'Watch-paralysis' has its own subreddit. Streamers are quietly experimenting with 'shuffle' buttons that just play something.
- 6 British baby names are getting shorter again — three- and four-letter names are dominating the registrar.**
Top picks this year: Noa, Ezra, Ada and Bo. Long, multi-syllable Victorian names like Theodora are sliding back down the chart.
- 7 A survey says most of us secretly prefer a night in with a quiz on the telly to a night out.**
Shouting answers at the screen remains the nation's favourite low-effort sport — even when we're completely wrong.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Over half of us confess we've kept THIS appliance long after it broke 'just in case'.

ANSWER: A TOASTER THAT ONLY DOES ONE SIDE.

Q The number one thing we pretend to understand but don't is THIS.

ANSWER: HOW OUR OWN PENSION WORKS.

TALK TOPIC

- **New research suggests the happiest people have a 'small ritual' that starts their day.**
What's the little thing you do every morning that sets you up — and what happens if you skip it?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Sea otters hold hands while they sleep so they don't drift apart on the water. They sometimes also wrap themselves in seaweed to stay anchored.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A wildlife park has started giving its giraffes scarves in winter, after a vet decided their long necks were 'the bit that feels the cold first'.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£59 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£59 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of crows is called a 'murder'. A group of owls is a 'parliament'.
- The Eiffel Tower was meant to be temporary — it was almost torn down after 20 years.
- Sharks existed before trees. Sharks have been around for over 400 million years.
- The unicorn is the official national animal of Scotland.
- Venus is the hottest planet in the solar system, even though Mercury is closer to the Sun.
- A bolt of lightning is roughly five times hotter than the surface of the Sun.
- The shortest war in history lasted under 40 minutes — between Britain and Zanzibar in 1896.
- Scotland has more than 790 islands, though most are uninhabited.

On this day

Day 239 of the year, 126 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Baculus of Sorrento; Christian feast day: Caesarius of Arles; Christian feast day: David Lewis; Christian feast day: Decuman. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1969 — Mark Ealham, English cricketer
- 1942 — Daryl Dragon, American keyboard player and songwriter (died 2019)
- 1985 — Kevan Hurst, English footballer
- 1981 — Patrick J. Adams, Canadian actor
- 1975 — Mase, American rapper, songwriter and pastor
- 1948 — John Mehler, American drummer
- 1961 — Mark Curry, English television host and actor
- 1947 — Barbara Bach, American actress and model

THE DAY TODAY

- 1955 — The first edition of the Guinness Book of Records is published in Great Britain.
- 1975 — The Governor of Portuguese Timor abandons its capital, Dili, and flees to Atauro Island, leaving control to a rebel group.
- 1979 — The Troubles: Eighteen British soldiers are killed at the Warrenpoint ambush by the Provisional Irish Republican Army near Warrenpoint, Northern Ireland, in the deadliest attack on British forces during Operation Banner. An IRA bomb also kills British royal family member Lord...

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2009 — Internal conflict in Myanmar: The Burmese military junta and ethnic armies begin three days of violent clashes in the Kokang Special Region.
- 1992 — Aeroflot Flight 2808 crashes on approach to Ivanovo Yuzhny Airport, killing all 84 aboard.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1982 — Turkish military diplomat Colonel Atilla Altıkat is shot and killed in Ottawa. Justice Commandos of the Armenian Genocide claim to be avenging the massacre of 1+½ million Armenians in the 1915 Armenian genocide.

1991 — The European Community recognizes the independence of the Baltic states of Estonia, Latvia and Lithuania.

- 1939 — First flight of the turbojet-powered Heinkel He 178, the world's first jet aircraft.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 240 of the year, 125 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alexander of Constantinople; Christian feast day: Augustine of Hippo; Christian feast day: Edmund Arrowsmith; Christian feast day: Florentina. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1970 — Rick Recht, American singer-songwriter
- 1943 — Robert Greenwald, American director and producer
- 1982 — Kevin McNaughton, Scottish footballer
- 1945 — Bob Segarini, American-Canadian singer-songwriter (died 2023)
- 1925 — Billy Grammer, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2011)
- 2000 — Marissa Bode, American actress
- 1962 — Paul Allen, English footballer
- 1956 — Steve Whiteman, American singer-songwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1998 — Second Congo War: Loyalist troops backed by Angolan and Zimbabwean forces repulse the RCD and Rwandan offensive on Kinshasa.
- 2009 — NASA's Space Shuttle Discovery launches on STS-128.
- 1993 — The autonomous Croatian Community of Herzeg-Bosnia in Bosnia and Herzegovina is transformed into the Croatian Republic of Herzeg-Bosnia.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1955 — Black teenager Emmett Till is lynched in Mississippi for whistling at a white woman, galvanizing the nascent civil rights movement.
- 1944 — World War II: Marseille and Toulon are liberated.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar